# 12 Herbs Every Woman Should Know



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# THE IDEA BEHIND THIS GUIDE

## Some knowledge was never meant to be forgotten.

Long before wellness became an industry, plants were part of everyday life. Today, researchers are taking a closer look at many of those same botanicals. This guide is not a list of miracle cures. It is an invitation to become familiar with what is in your cup - and to understand the difference between tradition, early research, and stronger human evidence.

### How to read the research notes

**Human study** means researchers tested a preparation in people. It does not automatically mean the same result will occur with every dose, product, or tea.

**Extract is not the same as tea.** Several herbs have been studied as concentrated extracts or capsules. Where that matters, we say so.

**Limited evidence** is still useful information. Some botanicals are centuries old in traditional use but surprisingly under-studied in modern clinical trials.

CURIOSITY + CONTEXT + CAUTION

### Please read this first.

**Educational information only.** This guide is not medical advice and is not intended to diagnose, treat, cure, or prevent any disease.

Herbs may cause side effects or interact with medicines. Talk with an appropriate healthcare professional before using herbal products if you are pregnant, breastfeeding, taking medication, preparing for surgery, or managing a medical condition.

Do not stop, replace, or change prescribed treatment based on this guide. Research described here may involve extracts or doses that are not equivalent to a brewed tea.

**The standard:** no hype, no magic language, no pretending preliminary research is proof.

> "You do not have to become an herbalist. You can simply become more informed about the plants you choose to bring into your life."



# ROOT SOLUTIONS FOR ROOT CAUSES





## Hibiscus

01

**THE BLOOD PRESSURE AND HEART HERB RESEARCHERS KEEP STUDYING**

Hibiscus is one of the best-studied herbs in this blend for healthy blood pressure and circulation.
That matters even more after 40, when changes in hormones can also affect your heart and blood vessels.

**RESEARCH SNAPSHOT**

A 2022 systematic review found hibiscus consumption was associated with lower systolic blood pressure across controlled trials;



## Spearmint Leaf

02

**THE MINT THAT COULD ERASE CHIN HAIR**

Spearmint has actually been studied in women with unwanted facial hair.
Women drinking spearmint tea had changes in testosterone levels, including the type of testosterone that can play a role in chin hair and other unwanted hair growth. This is one of our favorite herbs for women.

**RESEARCH SNAPSHOT**

In a 30-day randomized trial, spearmint tea lowered free and total testosterone and improved participants' self-rated hirsutism.[2]



## Red Raspberry Leaf

03

**A FAMOUS, HISTORIC WOMEN'S HERB**

Researchers have found that it can interact with the muscles of the uterus, which may help explain why it has such a long history as a women's herb. There is newer preclinical research suggesting raspberry-leaf polyphenols may influence inflammation and endometriotic lesions, but that is not yet clinical proof.

**RESEARCH SNAPSHOT**

A2021 review concluded that raspberry leaf is widely used in pregnancy, but the evidence for safety and effectiveness is still being studied. Pregnancy use should be discussed with a qualified clinician.[3]

AROMATIC + CARDIOVASCULAR TRADITIONS

# Three herbs with very different stories.

HERBS 04-06



## Lemongrass

04

**NOT JUST A PRETTY GRASS WITH A GORGEOUS SCENT**

More than a bright citrus herb. Research is exploring lemongrass for menstrual cramps, pelvic discomfort, and menopause symptoms, PLUS its citral compounds that provide antioxidant and anti-inflammatory support.

**RESEARCH SNAPSHOT**

A small human study of lemongrass tea found no meaningful changes in a range of metabolic laboratory measures after two weeks. Useful reminder: limited evidence is not the same as proven benefit or proven harm.[4]



## Hawthorn Leaf & Flower

05

**THE OLD EUROPEAN HEART HERB MODERN TRIALS NOTICED**

Hawthorn has a long cardiovascular tradition, and recent analyses suggest possible blood-pressure effects
Guide gold: midlife circulation/vascular support, especially in a formula designed around women's BP—not "treats hypertension."

**RESEARCH SNAPSHOT**

A randomized controlled trial in people with type 2 diabetes taking prescription medicines found a blood-pressure effect from a hawthorn extract. That concentrated preparation should not be treated as equivalent to a tea blend.[5]



## Fennel Seed

06

**SWEET, AROMATIC, AND STUDIED IN MENOPAUSE**

A randomized triple-blind placebo-controlled trial in 90 postmenopausal women ages 45–60 found significantly improved menopause symptom scores. Other work reports improvements in areas including vasomotor complaints, vaginal dryness/itching, painful intercourse and aspects of sexual health.
Guide gold: menopause + feminine comfort + sexual wellness.

**RESEARCH SNAPSHOT**

In arandomized,triple-blind, placebo-controlled trial, fennel was associated with improved menopausal symptom scores in postmenopausal women. The authors called for additional clinical trials.[6]



If you use heart, blood-pressure, glucose or other medicines, discuss herbs with your clinician.

LEAVES + FLOWERS FOR THE DAILY CUP

# Familiar plants. More nuanced evidence.





## Nettle Leaf

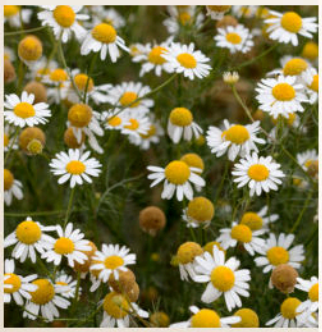
07

**THE PRICKLY PLANT THAT BECOMES GENTLE IN THE CUP**

A randomized controlled study found Urtica dioica reduced menopausal hot flashes and improved quality of life in postmenopausal women compared with placebo/sham control.
Guide gold: “Nettle isn't just a mineral-rich old-world herb. It has actually been studied in postmenopausal women for hot flashes and quality of life.” Also great for blood sugar control

**RESEARCH SNAPSHOT**

Inarandomized double-blind clinical trial, Urtica dioica leaf extract improved glycemic control measures in adults with advanced type 2 diabetes. This was an extract study, not a test of ordinary nettle tea.[7]



## Chamomile Flower

08

**THE BEDTIME CLASSIC WITH HUMAN TEA RESEARCH**

Chamomile has a much richer female story than “relaxation.” Research has examined it for dysmenorrhea, menstrual bleeding and menstrual-related emotional symptoms. A 2024 systematic review/meta-analysis also found improvements in aspects of sleep. Cramps + emotional irritability + sleep disruption. That's an extremely relatable women-40+ combination.

**RESEARCH SNAPSHOT**

Inarandomized study ofsleep-disturbed postpartum women, those assigned to drink chamomile tea reported improvements in sleep quality and fatigue compared with controls.[8]



## Sage Leaf

09

**A KITCHEN HERB THAT STEPPED INTO MENOPAUSE RESEARCH**

Sage should be one of the headline herbs. A 2023 systematic review found all four included studies reported reductions in frequency and severity of menopausal hot flashes.

**RESEARCH SNAPSHOT**

A2011clinical trial of a fresh sage preparation reported reduced frequency and severity of hot flushes over eight weeks. .[9]

ROOTS + BLOSSOMS

# Finish with warmth, color, and calm.





## Ginger Root

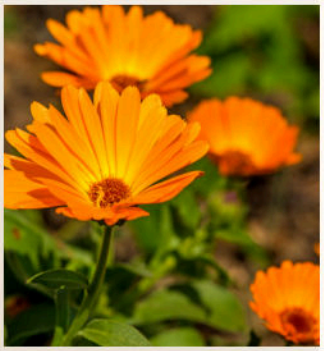
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**THE WARM ROOT YOUR PERIOD WILL LOVE**

Ginger isn't just there for digestion. Multiple randomized trials and reviews support a meaningful signal for primary dysmenorrhea, and a controlled trial found substantially reduced menstrual blood loss in young women

**RESEARCH SNAPSHOT**

Inaplacebo-controlled randomized trial, young women taking ginger during menstruation reported greater reduction in primary dysmenorrhea pain than the placebo group.[10]



## Calendula Petals

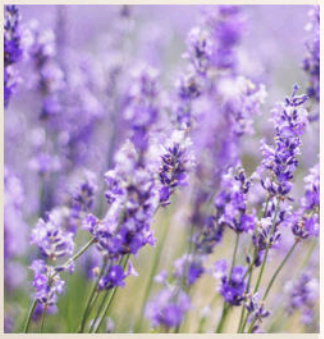
11

**THE GOLDEN FLOWER WITH STRONGER TOPICAL THAN TEA EVIDENCE**

There are impressive women-specific trials involving calendula vaginal creams for candidiasis and bacterial vaginosis. There is also intriguing animal PCOS research involving follicle development and ovulation. It's also used as a skin therapy as the skin-queen

**RESEARCH SNAPSHOT**

Asystematic reviewfoundpromising but mixed clinical evidence for topical calendula in wound healing, with study quality limiting firm conclusions. [11]



## Lavender Flower

12

**A FRAGRANCE FIRST - WITH EMERGING TEA RESEARCH**

Research in postmenopausal women has explored lavender for sleep, hot flashes, mood, anxiety and sexual function. NIH specifically notes preliminary evidence for menopause-related sexual dysfunction,

**RESEARCH SNAPSHOT**

Arandomized clinicaltrial in older adults found that lavender herbal tea was associated with lower anxiety and depression scores. It was one study in a specific population, not proof of a treatment effect for everyone.[12]



Research form matters: tea, extract, capsule, topical cream and essential oil are not interchangeable.

# Now Look At What Happens When They Work Together

**Not one “magic herb.”**
**But 12 plants working to support different parts of a woman's changing body.**

1. **Spearmint → Chin hair + androgens**
2. **Sage + Fennel + Nettle → Hot flashes + menopause**
3. **Chamomile + Lavender → Sleep + stress + mood**
4. **Ginger + Lemongrass + Raspberry Leaf → Periods + feminine comfort, libido**
5. **Hibiscus + Hawthorn → Blood pressure + heart + circulation**

**Because after 40, these things aren't always separate.**

- **Your sleep can affect your blood pressure.**
- **Your hormones can affect your hair.**
- **Your stress can affect your heart.**
- **Your changing cycle can affect how you feel from head to toe.**

**That's why we built STEADY for the whole woman.**

**See the Research →**

NOW THE PART THAT MAKES THIS SIMPLE

# Twelve remarkable botanicals.
# One beautifully prepared blend.

You can buy twelve herbs, compare quality, store twelve bags, measure each one and build your own blend. Or GRAB your bag pre-mixed in just the right amounts today.

## THE FORSAKEN TRUTH - STEADY

STEADY is our naturally caffeine-free loose-leaf herbal tea built around these 12 intentional botanicals. Each herb supports your hormones, heart, mood, energy, sleep or blood pressure.

**What you get:** a thoughtful blend for the woman over 40 who is ready for her body to be hers again

DISCOVER STEADY

**Scan to see the tea**
bpquiz.com/tea
Use the guide for education only




Made by Nature.
Rooted in Science.



THE
FORSAKEN TRUTH

# Return to The Forsaken Truth



## For the woman ready to come back to herself.

The Forsaken Truth is a return to what is real, rooted, and restoring. A beautiful reminder that wellness does not begin with more noise — it begins by coming back to yourself.



HERBS ARE ONE PIECE OF THE PICTURE

## If You Are Serious About Becoming Well...

Join The Change My Life Challenge For Help Getting To The Source Of Your Changes After 40

Change Your Health To Change Your Life.  Click Below To Join The Next Challenge

**JOIN THE CHALLENGE**

changemylifechallenge.com

## Research & references

ClickaPubMedlinkinthedigitalversiontoreview the source. Research quality and preparation type vary by herb.


**1. Hibiscus.** Ellis LR, et al. (2022). *A systematic review and meta-analysis of the effects of Hibiscus sabdariffa on blood pressure and cardiometabolic markers.* PMID 34927694. PubMed.

**2. Spearmint.** Grant P. (2010). *Spearmint herbal tea has significant anti-androgen effects in polycystic ovarian syndrome: a randomized controlled trial.* PMID 19585478. PubMed.

**3. Raspberry leaf.** Bowman R, et al. (2021). *Biophysical effects, safety and efficacy of raspberry leaf use in pregnancy: a systematic integrative review.* PMID 33563275. PubMed.

**4. Lemongrass.** Leite JR, et al. (1986). *Pharmacology of lemongrass (Cymbopogon citratus Stapf): assessment of eventual toxic, hypnotic and anxiolytic effects on humans.* J Ethnopharmacol. PMID 2429120. PubMed.

**5. Hawthorn.** Walker AF, et al. (2006). *Hypotensive effects of hawthorn for patients with diabetes taking prescription drugs: a randomised controlled trial.* Br J Gen Pract. PMC.

**6. Fennel.** Rahimikian F, et al. (2017). *Effect of Foeniculum vulgare Mill. (fennel) on menopausal symptoms in postmenopausal women: a randomized, triple-blind, placebo-controlled trial.* PMID 28509813. PubMed.

**7. Nettle.** Kianbakht S, et al. (2013). *Improved glycemic control in patients with advanced type 2 diabetes mellitus taking Urtica dioica leaf extract: a randomized double-blind placebo-controlled clinical trial.* PMID 24273930. PubMed.

**8. Chamomile.** Chang SM, Chen CH. (2016). *Effects of an intervention with drinking chamomile tea on sleep quality, fatigue and depression in sleep-disturbed postnatal women: a randomized controlled trial.* PMID 26483209. PubMed.

**9. Sage.** Bommer S, Klein P, Suter A. (2011). *First time proof of sage's tolerability and efficacy in menopausal women with hot flushes.* PMID 21630133. PubMed.

**10. Ginger.** Kashefi F, et al. (2014). *Comparison of the effect of ginger and zinc sulfate on primary dysmenorrhea: a placebo-controlled randomized trial.* Pain Manag Nurs. PMID 24559600. PubMed.

**11. Calendula.** Givol O, et al. (2019). *A systematic review of Calendula officinalis extract for wound healing.* PMID 31145533. PubMed.

**12. Lavender.** Bazrafshan MR, et al. (2020). *The effect of lavender herbal tea on the anxiety and depression of the elderly: a randomized clinical trial.* PMID 32444033. PubMed.


**Safety reminder:** Herbs and medicines can interact. Hawthorn in particular has clinically relevant cautions for people taking cardiovascular medicines, and the safety of some herbs during pregnancy or breastfeeding is uncertain. Chamomile also has reported or theoretical drug interactions. If you take medication or have a medical condition, review herbal use with your healthcare professional. Sources: NIH/NCCIH safety guidance.


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